

LICENSED EMPLOYEE TRANSFERS AND INVOLUNTARY REASSIGNMENTS

The procedure for transferring licensed employees is divided into two (2) rounds. Round 1 has two primary functions. The first function is to identify any employee who will be involuntarily reassigned from their current school due to actions including but not limited to boundary or enrollment changes or the opening of new schools, all of which will affect student population at existing schools. The second function is to allow eligible employees to submit applications to volunteer to be transferred to preferred schools (including new schools) or licensure areas. Round 2 follows Round 1 and is designed to fill vacant licensed positions at new and existing schools. Licensed employees who are involuntarily reassigned may also apply for a voluntary transfer to any openings posted in Round 2. Following the conclusion of Round 2, exceptions may be made to allow for voluntary transfers when certain approvals and criteria are met.

A. Description of Licensed Transfer Process and Procedures for Voluntary Transfers

1. During Round 1, licensed employees seeking a change of location or licensure area are invited to submit an online application in the Licensed Transfer Process during a set period of not less than 30 days. Employees requesting a transfer are asked to provide certain demographic information about themselves, as well as relevant work experience. A transfer request is not complete unless the application is submitted.

2. Principals can access Round 1 transfer information via the applicant tracking system and can choose to contact these individuals for an interview at the conclusion of the Round 1 period. Principals have no less than 30 days to conduct interviews with transfer applicants. Principals recommend internal candidates to transfer to their schools/positions to the Department of Human Resources and Talent Development at the conclusion of Round 1.

3. Principals may be limited in the number of licensed staff members they may request from one school location. No more than 25% of current staff from one school should be requested; however, that percentage could be less depending on division needs.

4. The Department of Human Resources and Talent Development then reviews the transfer requests from principals, and confirms each selected employee's eligibility for the voluntary transfer.

5. The Department of Human Resources and Talent Development then offers the voluntary transfer position to the selected employee, and confirms the voluntary transfer in writing.

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6. If the employee accepts the voluntary transfer, they are not eligible to accept another voluntary transfer unless it is for a position that is considered a promotion or demotion from their current teaching assignment.

7. During Round 2 of the Licensed Transfer Process, all vacant licensed positions are posted internally and externally simultaneously, until filled. Department of Human Resources and Talent Development may request that a position only be posted internally unless the position has otherwise been identified as a promotional opportunity. No posting will be posted externally only.

8. Any licensed employee meeting the eligibility requirements, and who has not already accepted a voluntary transfer, can apply during Round 2 to positions of interest and for which they are qualified. Current employees should apply through the applicant tracking system. Employees must complete and submit the required application documents in order to be considered an eligible candidate.

9. Principals and program supervisors may choose whom to interview for their posted positions (i.e., internal and/or external candidates), and recommend internal candidates for transfer (or external candidates to hire) to the Department of Human Resources and Talent Development.

10. Department of Human Resources and Talent Development then reviews the transfer request from the principal for an internal candidate and confirms the selected employee's eligibility for a voluntary transfer.

11. The Department of Human Resources and Talent Development then offers the voluntary transfer position to the selected employee, and confirms the voluntary transfer in writing.

12. If the employee accepts the voluntary transfer, they are not eligible to accept another voluntary transfer unless it is for a position that is considered a promotion or demotion from their current teaching assignment (an exception is provided for employees who have been subject to an involuntary reassignment, which is detailed in Section D).

13. Round 2 of the Licensed Transfer Process ends on June 15 or the next business day of the month if June 15 falls on a weekend. In most cases, Round 2 internal applicants will be notified of a transfer by the conclusion of Round 2.

14. Following the conclusion of Round 2, a principal may request that a current eligible licensed employee be permitted to voluntarily transfer to a position at their school even though the Licensed Transfer Process has concluded. In those instances, the transfer must occur by the start date of the teacher contract for the

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upcoming school year, both the requesting and current principals must agree to the transfer, the Department of Human Resources and Talent Development must approve the transfer, and the transfer should not have an overall negative impact on the school division, such as creating a vacancy in a high need area that would be difficult to fill. Employees would need to apply through the applicant tracking system to be considered eligible to transfer in these circumstances (since the Licensed Transfer Process has ended).

15. Exceptions following the conclusion of Round 2 are also intended to allow for an involuntarily reassigned employee to be returned to their original school if a position becomes available following the conclusion of the Licensed Transfer Process, and all the above approval criteria are met.

B. Procedures for Placing Employees Identified for Involuntary Reassignment

1. Principals shall submit to the Department of Human Resources and Talent Development their recommendations for involuntary reassignment from their schools. Upon receipt of the recommendations, the Department of Human Resources and Talent Development will ensure the correct employees have been identified using the length of service and exception criteria, and will approve or deny the recommendations.

2. The Department of Human Resources and Talent Development, sometimes in collaboration with the Department of Instruction particularly for Elementary specialist endorsements, will then identify placements for the affected employees that are comparable to their current FTE assignment and by using the following criteria, in no prescribed order:

- a. the employee's endorsement areas;
- b. the employee's most recent teaching assignment;
- c. the employee's home address; and,
- d. the employee's request for a particular placement location or assignment.

3. The Department of Human Resources and Talent Development or the Department of Instruction will then notify the Principal of the employee's placement. The Principal then notifies the employee of their new placement, preferably meeting with the employee.

4. The Department of Human Resources and Talent Development will then confirm the involuntary reassignment placement in writing.

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5. Licensed employees who are involuntarily reassigned will be eligible to apply for a voluntary transfer to another position more suited to their preferences, to include a transfer back to a position at their original schools, during Round 2 of the Licensed Transfer Process, or following Round 2 if all approval criteria are met.

6. A licensed employee who was involuntarily reassigned and who then accepted a voluntary transfer offer to another position may apply for a second voluntary transfer only if that transfer would take them back to their original school.

7. Once a voluntary transfer is accepted to a position returning an employee to their original school, the employee becomes ineligible for any additional voluntary transfers unless it is for a position that is considered a promotion or demotion from their current teaching assignment.

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